

would lead her to a deeper understanding of theoretical concepts, or when classroom lessons would provide clarity for coding challenges.

“It wasn’t about balancing two different things,” she says. “It was about integrating them. One side gave me structure, the other gave me freedom to explore. Together, they made the learning experience richer.”

Role of AI in learning

Saanvi is quick to credit tools like ChatGPT for aiding her app development. “Sometimes when you’re learning to code, you hit a wall,” she says. “AI can explain things in different ways until something clicks. It doesn’t just give answers, it helps you understand why something works or doesn’t work.”

While she acknowledges the value of AI, she’s clear that it’s no replacement for the learning process itself. “AI is a tool that helps us do what we do better,” she says. “The real magic happens when you combine that support with your own creativity and effort.”

Insights and inspiration

Winning the Swift Student Challenge was a milestone for Saanvi, but she remains focused on the journey ahead. If given the chance to ask an Apple engineer a question at WWDC, she says it would be: “How do you know when you’ve solved a problem well enough? What separates something that just works from something that really resonates with people?”

For Saanvi, great apps aren’t defined by their complexity or flashy features. They’re defined by how well they solve a problem and the clarity of intention behind them.

Advice for aspiring innovators

To students considering entering the Swift Student Challenge, Saanvi’s advice is simple yet profound. “Don’t start with an idea just because it sounds impressive. Start with something that makes sense to you - something you care about,” she emphasises. ▶

Your AI-powered cross-platform dev toolkit

A new wave of AI tools lets student developers build, test, and ship apps for iOS, Android, web, and desktop – without locking into a single ecosystem. From copilots that finish your functions to no-code builders that turn plain English into working UIs, here’s a fast tour of what to try next.

1. Code-First Copilots

- **GitHub Copilot** plugs into VS Code, Xcode, Android Studio and more, autocompleting widgets, tests, and boilerplate for Flutter, React Native, or native stacks.
- **Amazon CodeWhisperer** adds real-time suggestions plus built-in security scanning across 15+ languages – handy for AWS-backed mobile back-ends.
- **Google Gemini Code Assist** brings full-file generation and refactoring in JetBrains IDEs, VS Code, and Firebase, spanning Java to Kotlin to Swift.

2. No-/Low-Code Builders

- **FlutterFlow** lets you drag-and-drop Flutter components, inject custom Dart, and one-click deploy to App Store, Play Store, and web.
- **Appy Pie’s AI App Generator** turns domain-specific prompts (“build a hyperlocal grocery app”) into ready-to-publish binaries – no SDK installs needed.
- **Replit Agent** creates full-stack projects (frontend, database, auth) from a chat prompt, then hosts them free – great for hackathon MVPs.

3. Test & Tweak with AI

- **Kobiton’s AI-Augmented Testing** records a session, auto-generates Appium scripts, and self-heals them when UI IDs change – cutting regression cycles by up to 92%.

4. Smart Back-Ends & Gen AI

- **Firebase Genkit** brings retrieval-augmented generation, vector search, and Gemini models straight into your Node/Next.js or Android app.
- **OpenAI GPT-4.1** (API-only) now supports 1 M-token contexts and discounted “nano” tiers—handy for in-app chatbots or code-review agents.
- **Microsoft Azure AI Studio** ships C# and TypeScript templates that wire Azure OpenAI, Cosmos DB, and GitHub Copilot into cloud-native microservices.

With this AI-powered mix, you can go from idea to cross-platform release in weeks – not semesters – while keeping your codebase.